I didn’t have an issue with his view, as such, because he had every right to an opinion, but I expected greater understanding from someone who knew what I had gone through in the previous eight months.

I regard him as a good friend. We’d shared beds in India, shared dressing rooms around the world. I had his back when he wanted to retire midway through an Ashes series. I now have even greater cause to understand the inevitable conflict when a senior player pursues a secondary career in the media, but at the time I felt genuinely let down.

‘Couldn’t you just see it from my point of view?’ I asked him. To be fair, he apologized, but the agenda had been re-inforced. Moores felt he should have been more proactive with the media, in explaining the thinking behind the transition to a new generation of players shaped by the limited-overs game. Our plan was to introduce them gradually, rather than all at once.

I was obviously vulnerable. Results, the ultimate arbiter, weren’t good. We had brief bursts of success but lost consecutive one-day series to India and Sri Lanka. I wasn’t producing the goods. I was assured that the selectors retained faith in me, but the proximity of the World Cup inevitably concentrated minds.

I wanted to complete my four-year cycle as one-day captain. After all, we became number one on my watch, and only a late-innings collapse in the 2013 Champions Trophy final against India at Edgbaston stopped us from winning England’s first major final in five attempts. We had picked a team suited to fifty-over cricket that day, but rain reduced it to a twenty-over thrash.

Moores backed me publicly, as World Cup captain, just before Christmas. But, given the selection meeting was obviously going to focus on my position, I recognized a potential conflict of interest, and withdrew from it. Had I joined Peter Moores, James Whitaker, Mick Newell and Gus Fraser, I would have argued for stability, because wholesale changes in the build-up to previous major tournaments had been counter-productive.

I told Alice I intended to call Peter on the day of that meeting, to stress that I didn’t want him to feel pressurized by his public show of faith. Above all, I wanted him to be honest. That might sound a bit naïve and unworldly, but I didn’t want to sit there thinking he had backed me as one-day captain out of a misplaced sense of loyalty.

‘I know there’s a lot to talk about,’ I told him. ‘I still think I’m the right man to be captain, but be true to yourself. The form over the past twelve